Thank-You Note (Paper)

Handwritten on real paper, mailed within two business days. They almost never happen anymore — which is exactly why the most memorable one on the desk is yours.

A good note card is fine; a plain piece of nice paper folded well is fine too. Blue or black ink, a pen that doesn't smear when you're hurrying (so: test it first).

WRITE THE DATE SMALL, TOP RIGHT, LIKE THIS:

GREETING — FIRST NAME IS FINE HERE; THEY'VE SEEN YOU IN PERSON:

LINE 1 · THE THANK-YOU, PLAIN:

LINE 2 · ONE DETAIL ONLY THEY COULD HAVE GIVEN YOU:

LINE 3 · YOU'RE STILL INTERESTED, SAID ONCE AND CALMLY:

SIGN-OFF — WARM, SHORT:

THE TWO-MINUTE VERSION TO COPY OUT BY HAND

```
Dear [First Name], Thank you for meeting with me [yesterday/this morning] about [role]. Talking with you about [ONE REAL THING] was the part I keep thinking about since. I'm glad to be considered, and I'd be glad to come back for whatever's next. With thanks, [your name]
```

MAIL-DAY CHECKLIST

- [ ] Address readable (print it if your cursive is weather-polished — legible beats fancy).
- [ ] Stamp today, in the mailbox today — notes that sit become "never sent."
- [ ] One extra card for the person who scheduled anything? Worth the stamp.
- [ ] Sent the email thank-you too? Good — different notes, different strengths.

> Your handwriting doesn't have to be pretty. It has to be yours — unhurried, honest, and signed. Every other candidate's note that week will be typed; this one will be picked up twice.

Sent both kinds where you could? Log it in the Post-Interview Reflection Log and leave the rest of the evening alone. Rest counts as job prep too — that's the part nobody tells you, and the part that's actually true.